

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« **Rafael Nadal is the master of underpromising and overdelivering.**

— Former American tennis player Andy Roddick sceptical of the Spaniard's doubts about French Open 2024 participation »



« **Well, who is going to say now that women's tennis is boring, right? I think it was the most intense and, like, crazy final I played.**

— Iga Swiatek, after a gruelling three-hour 11-minute victory against Aryna Sabalenka at the Madrid Open »

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The International Olympic Committee (IOC) has suspended former Olympic power broker Sheikh Ahmad al-Fahad al-Sabah of Kuwait for 15 years after his conviction for forgery was upheld on appeal this year at a Swiss criminal appeals court.

Sheikh Ahmad's sanction for "a betrayal of his IOC Member's oath, as well as the seriousness of the damage to the IOC's reputation" was approved by the Olympic body's executive board. The 15-year suspension

starts from the date of his previous ban for a separate issue of unethical conduct, in an Olympic Council of Asia election. That was a three-year sanction imposed on July 27 last year. Sheikh Ahmad led the Olympic Council of Asia, created by his father in Kuwait, before joining the IOC in 1992.



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The Los Angeles Lakers fired head coach Darvin Ham after two seasons and a 90-74 regular-season record. The Lakers finished the regular season with a 47-35 mark, good enough for only an eighth-place finish in the Western Conference. They defeated the New Orleans Pelicans in the play-in round to earn the No. 7 seed in the playoffs, but were bounced by the Denver Nuggets in the opening round, 4-1. It was Ham's first NBA head coaching job.

HONOURED



Seven-time Olympic gold medallist swimmer Katie Ledecky was awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom by U.S. President Joe Biden. The 21-time World champion was among the 19 people, which included International Olympic Committee (IOC) member and actress Michelle Yeoh, and Jim Thorpe, to receive the highest U.S. civilian award. AP